EDUCATION

3 Mistakes Companies Make When Automating

And the exact fix for each. Save this before your next project kickoff.

01 NO OWNER

02 BUILT FOR TODAY

03 BUILT ALONE

AS MANY AS

30 TO 50%

of first RPA projects fail, in EY's experience. Their verdict: "This isn't a reflection of the technology."

WHAT WE SEE BREAK THEM

01 **Nobody owns it** after launch.

02 It's **built for today's volume** only.

03 It's **built in isolation** from the next team.

Source: EY, "Get ready for robots" (2016): "as many as 30 to 50% of initial RPA projects fail." RPA = robotic process automation, software that runs repetitive office work.

The system goes live. Then nobody owns it.

Launch day gets all the attention. After that, nobody is responsible for updates, for training new hires, or for making sure people actually use it. Small gaps pile up, and the team quietly drifts back to the old way.

HOW IT SHOWS UP

Side spreadsheets come back. Change requests go nowhere. Usage fades after the launch push.

Name the system owner on day one of the build. Not after launch.

One person, by name and role, accountable for the system once it's live. They help shape it during the build, so they know it inside out on launch day.

BUILD IT IN

- [x] A named owner, plus a backup
- [x] One simple path for change requests
- [x] Usage the owner can see, so drift shows early

It works great today. Then the volume doubles.

The system was scoped for this year's headcount, sites and order volume. When the business grows, it hits its ceiling, and the fix is a rebuild instead of an update.

HOW IT SHOWS UP

Slow screens at shift change. Workarounds for the new site. A second tool bolted on beside the first.

Start small. Build it to handle 3x your current volume.

A quick win is still the right first move. Just put it on a base that takes more users, sites and data without starting over. Growing a system is an update. Outgrowing one is a rebuild.

BUILD IT IN

- [x] Room for more users, sites and records
- [x] Lists and settings the owner changes, no code
- [x] Reports that still load fast at 3x the data

One department automates. The bottleneck moves to the handoff.

The new system works inside one team, but it doesn't talk to anyone upstream or downstream. Someone re-keys the data, emails a spreadsheet, or walks it over. The delay didn't disappear. It moved.

HOW IT SHOWS UP

Copy-paste between systems. "Did you get my email?" Two versions of the same number in two meetings.

Map the whole workflow. Then connect every handoff.

Scoping starts with the full path, from request to done, across every team it touches. Then the first piece is built to pass its data to the next one automatically, or with a clean connection ready for later.

BUILD IT IN

- [x] Every handoff mapped, upstream and downstream
- [x] Data entered once, used everywhere
- [x] Integrations planned from the first build

THE TAKEAWAY

None of these is a reason to wait. All three get built in from day one.

01 An owner named at kickoff

02 Room for 3x the volume

03 Every handoff connected

That's the difference between a tool people try and a system people run on.

Which of these three has derailed a project at your company?

Drop it in the comments. Save this for your next project kickoff.

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DM me for a free evaluation.

I'll map the workflow, flag all three risks, and estimate what it's costing you before you spend a dollar.

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